Tuesday Night Circle

Written by

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INT. COMMUNITY CENTER BASEMENT – EVENING
Characters-
Organizer
Participant 1/Frank
Participant 2/Mary
Participant 3/Sam
Participant 4/John

A circle of chairs. Yarn and knitting needles on everyone's laps. A cheap coffee pot in the corner. The ORGANIZER smiles warmly at the group.

ORGANIZER
Welcome, everyone, to Tuesday Night Circle. This is a safe space. A place where we stitch things together… one loop at a time. Can we start with names and how you ended up here with us?

PARTICIPANT 1
(grumpy, holding yarn)
Hello... I'm Frank.

EVERYONE
HI FRANK!

FRANK
My wife made me come. Said it'd be good for me to…

Frank raises up the bag of yarn

FRANK (cont'd)
knit.

ORGANIZER
Sometimes the people who love us know what's best. Why don't you share a little, just to cast on?

FRANK
(sighs)
Alright… I guess… I used to drink a lot. It got in the way of my job. My kids stopped talking to me. So… yeah. That's me.

A beat. The group shifts awkwardly.

PARTICIPANT 2
(book club lady)
Oh my god… me too. I'm Mary.

EVERYONE
HI MARY!

MARY
My daughter signed me up for this circle. I thought it was silly… but yeah, I—I lost everything for a while.

PARTICIPANT 3
(startup bro)
Whoa. Same. Oh... I'm Sam

EVERYONE
HI SAM!

SAM
I thought this was, like, a craft circle. But since we’re being honest—my drinking tanked my last startup. Like, investors left me for dead.

The group murmurs in surprise. Slowly, they start nodding in agreement.

ORGANIZER
Thank you for sharing. Each of you has picked up the needles tonight.

PARTICIPANT 4
(anger guy. Blurts out)
I smashed a drywall panel after a six-pack! My girlfriend said if I didn’t “learn to knit” I’d lose her. Guess I’m here. I'm John!

MARY
You’re not alone.

SAM
You know what? I haven’t had a drink in six months.

FRANK
Seriously? That’s huge!

The group claps enthusiastically, like it’s the most natural thing.

JOHN
I've only been sober three days… but… I'm trying!

MARY
That's amazing. Three days is where it starts.

They clap again. Everyone's smiling, a little emotional.

ORGANIZER
See? You've all made progress tonight. You came in with loose threads… and you're leaving with something stronger.

The group begins packing up their yarn and needles. They look confused but oddly uplifted.

FRANK
Wait a second. We didn't even knit anything.

ORGANIZER
(smiling)
Oh, you knitted something. Just not with yarn.

The group exchanges puzzled but warm looks.

FADE OUT